
ISAS Challenge 2026 - Submission Updates and Tutorials

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Dear Participants,

We hope that by this stage you have already developed your **location prediction models** using the provided training data. In your **challenge paper**, we expect you to describe:

- Your **training model and methodology**
- How you addressed **data limitations specific to location prediction**
- Key **challenges encountered** and suggested **future work**
- **Validation results** obtained using the training data

For validation, you may use approaches such as **Leave-One-Day-Out cross-validation**, **Stratified Random Split**, or any other reasonable strategy. Please report **training/validation performance only**. Final test-set performance will be computed by the organizers based on your submitted predictions.

Test Data:

https://drive.google.com/file/d/1_-ih1RLMnkDeoZSGi0cfC7jRVVuxOTqn/view?usp=sharing

The BLE test CSV files contain the following columns: user_id, timestamp, name, mac address, RSSI, power

You are expected to **add a column named Location** and fill it with your **predicted room labels per row**.

Focus of the Challenge

To ensure fairness and encourage strong model development, the **test data is being intentionally held**. Given the current timeline, the challenge will highlight Location Prediction as the primary task. Activity Prediction will be offered as an optional challenge task, as the activity labels for the test set are not yet being released.

Update on Activity Prediction

We are currently finalizing the activity labels and the corresponding evaluation materials. An update regarding the optional activity prediction task, will be shared tomorrow. We appreciate your patience and understanding while we complete the remaining preparations.

Short Tutorial Session - To assist participants with the test data and answer any questions, we will hold a short online tutorial:

 **Date: July 25, 2026**

 **Time: 11:00 AM JST**

Join Zoom Meeting

<https://us04web.zoom.us/j/79978948791?pwd=Y0YJrmkG59sw7pUTQsNtS2MbwUjaXH.1>

Meeting ID: 799 7894 8791

Passcode: 6N1hYf

The session will provide a brief overview of the test data, clarify the challenge requirements, and discuss the upcoming activity prediction update. We encourage all participants to attend.

Paper Writing Resources

If you found the tutorial helpful, please refer to the following materials:

- **Paper Writing Guideline (Recording):**
https://drive.google.com/file/d/1S0wzOTbR_5CSwabEJcJ0F8L97XA9Wjot/view
- **Challenge Paper Checklist:**
<https://docs.google.com/document/d/1n0olhPRhrxuwh9UvJbNhGQVnVTLfBUI5zE5urBpnOyM/view>
- **Challenge Paper Submission:**
The paper format will follow the ISAS conference guidelines detailed in <https://fas.hcmut.edu.vn/isas#contributors>

Like regular papers, challenge papers will undergo review process and we will release reviewer decision and comments. Similarly, once accepted, it will be published as Scopus-indexed. We look forward to your submission.

Start Your Challenge Paper Early

While refining your prediction models, we also encourage you to **begin writing your challenge paper in parallel**. In particular, you can already work on the following sections:

- **Introduction:** Describe the motivation, problem statement, and significance of activity and location recognition in care facilities.
- **Related Work:** Review existing studies on human activity recognition, indoor localization, multimodal sensor fusion, BLE beacon-based localization, and wearable sensing.
- **Methodology:** Document your proposed framework as it evolves, including preprocessing, feature extraction, model architecture, and validation strategy.

Confidentiality Notice

The **dataset and guide notebooks** are provided exclusively to **registered teams** as part of the learning experience in this challenge.

We kindly request that you **keep BOTH the data and notebooks confidential** and use them **solely for this competition**.

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All the best,

Christina Garcia, Dr. Ing

ISAS 2026 Challenge Chair

ABC 2027 Publication Chair

MDPI Sensors Special Issue Assistant Editor

